

However, this is not what made those of us watching the movie burst into peals of laughter. No, it took a special goof to do that! Angela is watching the security camera footage on her laptop. She's using Apple's QuickTime Media Player, the 'Q' icon is clearly visible, and when she notices her sister say something, she rewinds the clip. However, unlike any of us normal, everyday technology users, she doesn't use the progress bar; instead, she presses the 'Previous track' button.

There is a 'Rewind' button, but she clicks on the 'Previous' button. As any of us who have used a software media player will tell you, this button will take you back to the beginning of a clip, or even to a previous clip, but in this case, Angela magically rewinds the clip to exactly the right spot—talk about divine intervention!

OK, so some of you may argue that such a mistake isn't even noticeable and that we're nit-picking. True, perhaps most people will not even notice this error, and it is sort of minor, especially in a movie that deals with a much more serious subject—judgement day, evil, and God versus the devil! So what about movies that cover computers as a subject, and are targeted at us geeks?

The Net

Constantine merely started us off on this goof-hunt. The very next movie we decided to watch was *The Net*, starring Sandra Bullock. In no time flat, we were again rolling on the floor laughing. Sure, the movie is really old; sure, technology was just entering our lives back then, but the movie is about technology being evil and how our identities can be stolen using the Net!

This movie was a cult movie for us geeks, and was what sparked the interest in computers for quite a few of us. So imagine when we see the IP 23.75.345.200 being used in the movie! As most of us know, IP addresses are 8-bit numbers, and thus can only have values between zero and 255. The fact that the IP contains 345 means that someone didn't do their research properly.

Other stupid technology mistakes in *The Net* include viruses that blur your screen, obviously attacking your graphics card drivers and giving them the ability to display cool-looking distortions on the display. Yes, we *are* being sarcastic!

Overall, the way computer technology was depicted in *The Net* was unbelievable. Sure, the idea was that someone's electronic identity can be erased, but come on! Did she never sign



anything in her life? She never went to college? Had pictures taken for the annual yearbook? What about

college friends? Don't banks expect you to sign cheques?

The Net expected us to believe in a paperless world, yet even today, the world isn't that way. Still, it was a good movie that made us all a little scared of the Internet even in 1995.

The Core

In *The Core*, which was recently doing the rounds on a popular movie channel, there's a character called Rat who is supposed to be the world's best hacker. This character is skinny, sickly-looking and



Apparently, viruses can infect your monitor as well!

the stereotypical nerd. However, the task assigned to him is a little far-fetched: hack the Internet!

He is given the job of hacking the entire Internet, and prevent news of the mission to the centre of the earth from leaking. Sure, hackers have much power in the world of the Internet, but preventing the flow of information? Ridiculous at best!

He also hacks into any and everything in under two minutes flat!

However, computer technology had a very small role in this movie—most of it was dominated by unbelievable physics. For example, there is talk about the frequency of sound waves changing when passing through different mediums. Any physics student should be able to tell you that this is impossible—the amplitude and velocity can change, not the frequency.

Then there's *Unobtainium*! It's a magical metal that gets stronger with increased temperatures and pressures. Perhaps they should have called the metal "Unbelievable-anium"...

Overall, this movie was really bad for any science student to watch, not just computer geeks!

Hackers

Here's a movie that should send all *Digit* readers into fits of laughter!



Fictitious IPs were never 'that' unbelievable

